

Fueling Your Body

Eating healthy is not about strict diets or giving up the foods you love. Instead, it is about feeling great, having more energy, and keeping your body strong. A balanced diet provides your body with the nutrients it needs to function correctly.

Your diet should consist of:

- Half of your plate should consist of fruits and vegetables, which are full of vitamins and fiber.
- One-quarter of your plate should include lean proteins like chicken, fish, beans, or tofu to help build muscle.
- One-quarter of your plate should feature whole grains, such as brown rice or whole-wheat bread, which provide long-lasting energy.

Drinking enough water is another essential part of good nutrition. Sugary drinks, like soda and fruit juices with added sugar, can cause energy crashes and unwanted weight gain. Finally, listening to your body's hunger signals helps you stop eating when you are full, preventing overeating.

Vocabulary Focus

- **Nutrients:** Substances in food that your body needs to live, grow, and stay healthy.
- **Lean protein:** Protein sources that have a low fat content.
- **Whole grains:** Grains that retain all parts of the seed (e.g., oats, brown rice, whole wheat).

1. What is the main idea of the text?

- a) You must stop eating your favorite foods to be healthy.

- b) Healthy eating is about balance, variety, and listening to your body.
- c) Drinking water is the only way to lose weight.

2. How much of a balanced plate should consist of fruits and vegetables?

- a) One-quarter
- b) Half
- c) The whole plate

3. Why are whole grains beneficial?

- a) They help build muscle mass.
- b) They prevent you from ever feeling hungry.
- c) They give you long-lasting energy.

4. True or False: Sugary drinks can cause energy crashes.

5. True or False: You should ignore your body's full signals and keep eating until your plate is empty.